

Wits EBE FACULTY STUDENT COUNCIL INAUGURAL ENERGY INDABA
Energising the Future: Empowering Students for South Africa's Energy Sector

South Africa's energy sector faces significant challenges, with growing demand, constrained supply, and aging infrastructure that no longer meet modern needs. These realities highlight the urgent need for innovative approaches and professionals who can strengthen and transform the sector. As a leading institution, our university is dedicated to equipping future engineers with the expertise to navigate these complexities and develop meaningful solutions. This conference seeks to bridge the gap between academic training and the practical demands of the energy industry. Today's event aims to provide a platform for students to engage with real-world challenges, exchange ideas, and position themselves as key contributors to building a more resilient and sustainable energy future.

SENATE ROOM, SOLOMON MAHLANGU HOUSE, WITS UNIVERSITY

17H00 – 20H00

SEPTEMBER 25, 2025

Event Program

Program Director: Matsabane Carly Madiba

17:00 – 17:10 Welcome Address by Emmanuel Ndlovu – EBE Faculty Student Council Chairperson
Introduction to the conference's objectives and the importance of collaboration in addressing South Africa's energy challenges.

17:10 – 17:30 Mr Jacob Maroga – Manager | Energy Expert
Topic: Advancing innovation of clean energy solutions, rational energy use and practicality of a clean energy South Africa

17:30 – 18:00 Keynote Address by Hon. Kgositso Ramakgopa – Minister of Electricity and Energy
Topic: Navigating South Africa's Energy Challenges: Maintenance and mitigation of infrastructure degradation including plans to ensure sustainability through infrastructure development.

18:00 – 18:20 Prof. Thakozani Majozi – Dean of Engineering and the Built Environment
Topic: Engineering and the Built Environment: Bridging Education and Practice to Develop Future-Ready Engineers for South Africa's Energy Transition.

18:20 – 19:00 Q&A Session with the above 3 Speakers including the Hon. Minister
Interactive session with Q&A from students and attendees

19:05 – 19:20 Eskom's Role in the Energy Sector by Prof Lwazi Ngubevana – Technology Strategy Executive Group Strategy and sustainability specialist – Eskom
Topic: The future of SA as Energy producers in Africa and Exploring the role of energy storage technologies, including batteries and hydrogen, in addressing the intermittency of renewable energy sources.

19:20 – 19:50 Q&A Session with the second Session Speakers
Interactive session with Q&A from students and attendees.

19:50 – 20:00 Closing Remarks by Kerry-Anne Mafunga – EBE Faculty Student Council Treasurer

Refreshments served in the main foyer.